OWN YOUR FUTURE CHALLENGE · NASHVILLE · NOV 10, 2026

OwnTheBlock

The whole project from beginning to end, in plain words: my story, how it works, the blockchain, the money, the plan, and what still needs to change.

Fix the block. Own the block.

1 The competition and the rubric
2 My story and the problem
3 The solution, step by step
4 How a house gets bought
5 Who owns it and who runs it
6 Everything blockchain
7 The money for one house
8 Selling, exits and the buy-back
9 The plan and the lean budget
10 Risks, competition and impact
11 The 12-slide pitch
12 Q&A answers
13 What still needs to change

RED BOX
Needs to be fixed or checked

GOLD BOX
An idea we decided to add

GREEN BOX
Done or already strong

Kaleb Conway · Solo founder · Updated Nov 6, 2026 · Matches the deck OwnTheBlock_Pitch_Final.pptx (12 slides + backup)

PART 1

The competition and the rubric

I pitch for 5 minutes, then answer questions for 3 minutes. The judges score 7 things, and two of them are worth 20 points each.

Item	Detail
Event	Own Your Future Challenge, live pitch at the Annual HBCU AI & Fintech Conference, Nashville, TN
When and where	Tuesday, Nov 10, 2026, 9:40–10:25 AM ET, Seagrass/P01 room, Margaritaville Hotel
Format	5 minutes presenting + 3 minutes Q&A (Jade Kim's email)
Due to Jade	Slides and arrival/departure flight details by **Sunday, Nov 8**
Dinner	Monday, Nov 9, hosted by Base 11 (details coming)
Prizes	1st $5,000 · 2nd $2,500 · 3rd $1,500, announced the same day
Tie-breaker	The higher score in the blockchain category wins a tie

What the judges score, and where my deck covers it

Category	Points	What they want	My slides
Problem	5	A clear, precise problem	1–2
Use of blockchain	**20**	Why blockchain is the right tool, not just a buzzword	4, 5, 6
Action plan	**20**	Goals, resources, budget, timeline	9, 10
Feasibility	15	Risks named, with fixes	6, 11
Innovation	15	Something new, or an old idea used a new way	7
Benefits	15	Social impact, scale, fit with Coinbase's mission	3, 8
Pitch	10	Clear delivery, knowing the material, staying on time	All
Total	**100**	**Coinbase's mission: "increase economic freedom in the world"**	

CONFIRM WITH JADE

The challenge website says Nov 8 and a 3–5 minute pitch with about 10 minutes of Q&A. Jade's email says Nov 10 and 5 + 3. Plan for her email, ask her to confirm, and ask how travel is booked (the rules say through a Base 11 booking entity).

PART 2

My story and the problem

I open with what I've seen myself. There is no made-up character in the pitch anymore.

My story (slide 1)

SAY IT · ABOUT 25 SECONDS

"I grew up watching communities that were once wealthy Black neighborhoods change. Now the windows are boarded up, the houses sit vacant, and the people who live there just watch, because they can't do anything about it. It doesn't have to be this way. A century ago, Greenwood in Tulsa, Black Wall Street, showed what a community can build when it owns and reinvests in itself."

Why Black Wall Street

- Greenwood was a prosperous Black business district in Tulsa, Oklahoma, known as Black Wall Street.
- It was attacked May 31 to June 1, 1921. About 35 city blocks were destroyed, and a 2001 state commission estimated 100 to 300 deaths.
- I use it as proof of what a community can build when it owns and reinvests in itself. In the pitch it gets one sentence.

The problem (slide 2)

SAY IT · ABOUT 25 SECONDS

"Around our HBCUs I see the same boarded-up houses. Outside buyers pick them up, and the rent leaves the neighborhood. Black homeownership is 45 percent, versus 74 percent for white households, and homes are how families build wealth. Neighbors would chip in, but there's no way to turn ten dollars here and fifty there into owning a house."

Piece of the problem	In plain words
What happens	Houses go vacant, outside buyers take them, and rent leaves the neighborhood.
Who it hurts	Long-time residents of Black neighborhoods, including those around HBCUs like NC A&T and Bennett.
Why it matters	A home is most families' biggest asset, so the 29-point ownership gap becomes a wealth gap that gets passed down.
The root cause	Buying a house takes one big check, good credit and a down payment. Pooling lots of small checks has been too expensive to run.

WHAT CHANGED

Ms. Jenkins (a made-up neighbor from the earlier decks) is gone from the slides and the script. She only remains as the test character inside the demo code.

WATCH THE WORDING

"Value goes down" and "gentrified" can sound like opposites. Connect them: the neighborhood declines, houses go vacant, then outside buyers pick up the cheap homes. If a judge asks whether this is only for Black communities: the rules favor residency and local ties, never race, and I start around HBCUs because that's where I see the need.

VERIFY

Check the 45% and 74% figures against the latest Census Housing Vacancies and Homeownership release before Sunday. If you have a photo of a neighborhood you actually saw, swap it in on slide 2.

PART 3

The solution, step by step

About 1,250 neighbors, students and alumni each put in as little as $10. Together they raise $144,000 to buy and fix one house, and a local family rents it.

Neighbors invest from $10 on their phones › **Escrow bank** holds the money until the goal is hit › **House LLC** buys and fixes the house › **Local family** rents it, with a path to buy › **Owners** get rent monthly and vote

1. **Find the house.** Neighbors flag a vacant home. Main sources: heirs' property and city or county surplus homes.
2. **Check it.** Title search, as-is appraisal, inspection and two repair bids. Rule: never pay more than the appraisal.
3. **Make one LLC per house.** The LLC holds the deed. A house can't have 14,400 names on it, but an LLC can have that many members.
4. **Raise the money.** 14,400 tokens × $10 = $144,000, under SEC crowdfunding rules (Reg CF) through a registered portal.
   - Days 1–7: verified residents of the zip code.
   - Days 8–14: HBCU students and alumni.
   - Day 15 on: any verified U.S. investor.
   - No one can own more than 2% ($2,880). If the goal is missed, everyone is refunded automatically. People can cancel until 48 hours before the deadline.
5. **Buy and fix.** Local contractors are paid in stages, after each stage is inspected.
6. **Rent and pay.** A licensed property manager leases to a local family. What's left after bills is paid to owners every month.
7. **Vote and exit.** Owners vote on the Community Charter. The tenant can buy the home in years 3–7.

The Community Charter (the rulebook for each house)

Rule	What it means
2% cap	No single person can own more than 2% of a house
Local floor	A minimum share must stay with local owners, checked on every transfer
3% rent cap	Rent can't rise more than 3% a year
Changing a rule	Needs a two-thirds owner vote and a 30-day wait
Resident voice	Residents' votes count 1.5×
Steward	Co-signs every payment and can veto changes to the rent cap and reserve

Fairness	Rules favor residency, never race. An attorney reviews every Charter.

SAY IT · SLIDE 3

"OwnTheBlock fixes that. On the app I built, neighbors, students and alumni put in as little as ten dollars each, $144,000 together, enough to buy and fix one house. Each token is a share of an LLC that owns the deed. Residents get the first seven days, and no one can own more than 2 percent. A local family rents it, owners get paid monthly and vote, and the tenant can buy the home."

PART 4

How a house gets bought

There are four ways a house reaches the LLC. The slow sellers fit best, because a crowdfunded purchase takes about five to six months.

Where it comes from	Who sells	The catch
City or county surplus	The government (vacant or tax-foreclosed homes)	Often cheap, sometimes with a rule to renovate. **Main source.**
Probate / heirs' property	The estate's executor, or all the heirs	Every heir must sign, sometimes taking over a year. Don't open the raise until the title is clear. **Main source.**
Bank-owned (foreclosure)	The bank	Banks want fast cash closings, so it needs a bridge loan
A living owner	The homeowner	Any mortgage gets paid off at closing

Probate and tax-foreclosure rules differ by state. North Carolina details go to a real estate attorney.

How long it takes

When	What happens
Months 0–3 (once)	Set up the company, attorney, audit, steward and portal
Week 0	A neighbor or steward flags the house
Weeks 1–8	Title, appraisal, inspection, repair bids
Weeks 6–10	Form the LLC, write the Charter, sign the purchase deal
Weeks 10–20	The raise is open (residents first)
Weeks 20–24	Escrow releases the money and the deed goes to the LLC
Months 6–9	Renovate in stages
Month 9 on	A family moves in
Month 10 on	First monthly payout

IDEA WE ADDED: THE BRIDGE LOAN

When a seller can't wait, a community lender (a CDFI or community bank) lends the LLC the money to buy right away, and the neighborhood raise pays it back. Other speed-ups: an option contract that holds the house for about 90 days for a small fee, and opening the raise as soon as title and appraisal are done. Only use a bridge once a raise shows strong demand, because if the raise misses, the LLC still owes the lender.

What the family can choose (the Harris family example)

Three siblings inherited a house appraised at $90,000 and live out of state.

Option	Family gets	Best when
A. Sell	Cash at the appraised value, minus back taxes and liens	They just want out
B. Sell with buy-back	Cash now, plus the right to buy it back within 5 years at cost + 4% a year	They want to keep the family tie
C. Trade for shares	About half the tokens and no cash (Playbook example: 5,000 of 9,500 tokens, about 53%)	They have no cash but want to stay owners

Under option C the family gets a Charter-approved exception to the 2% cap, and their votes are capped at 25% on community decisions. If a homeowner lives in the house and wants to contribute it, they would deed it to the LLC for tokens and become a tenant under the capped-rent lease. Those details get settled with an attorney.

PART 5

Who owns it and who runs it

The investors own the house's LLC. OwnTheBlock runs it, and the community double-checks it.

Who	Role	Power and limits
Token holders	Own the LLC (each $10 token = 1 membership unit)	Get rent and a vote
OwnTheBlock	Manager of the LLC, runs day-to-day operations	Doesn't own the house. Can't change the Charter or move money alone.
Community steward	A church, neighborhood association, land trust or the city	Co-signs every payment. Can veto changes to the rent cap and reserve.
Property manager	Licensed, collects rent and handles repairs	Reports rent to the contract each month
Tenant	A local family	Capped rent, and the option to buy in years 3–7

IDEA WE ADDED: A COMMUNITY BOARD

As the number of houses grows, add a small board for each community so the neighborhood has a clear voice beyond one steward. The Playbook already points this way: payments signed by 3 of 5 board members, including 2 elected resident representatives.

- **Example seats:** the steward organization, 2 elected residents, the OwnTheBlock manager, and one more seat to decide (for example a tenant or a local advisor).
- **What it does:** approves spending, and can veto changes to the rent cap and reserve.
- **The trade-off:** it adds elections, rules for removing members and more legal setup.
- **How to say it:** "A community steward co-signs today. As houses multiply, I plan a resident-elected board."

STILL TO DECIDE

Who holds the fifth seat, how residents get elected, and when the board starts (for example at 3 houses or in the first city). This is not on a slide yet. Keep it as a Q&A answer.

PART 6

Everything blockchain

The blockchain is the public record and the rule-enforcer for money and ownership. The real world (the deed, the escrow bank, the legal owner list) is still proven with documents.

The basics

Term	Plain-English meaning
Blockchain	A shared notebook copied across thousands of computers. Everything is written in pen, so no single person can quietly erase or change it.
Base	The blockchain I use, built by Coinbase. Fees are under a penny.
USDC	A digital dollar that always equals $1, so payouts don't swing in value
Smart contract	A "robot referee": a small program that follows the rules the same way every time
Token	One $10 share of a house's LLC, recorded on Base. It is permissioned, so it only moves between people who passed an ID check.
Escrow	A neutral bank account that holds investors' money until the raise hits its goal, or refunds it

The five smart contracts (my five robot referees)

Contract	Its one job
IdentityRegistry	Records who is verified and who is a local resident. No personal data goes on-chain.
Raise	Runs the fundraise: residents first, all-or-nothing refunds, cancel until 48 hours before the deadline
BlockToken	The ownership shares. Enforces the 2% cap, the local floor, the 12-month lockup and the 3% rent cap, and pays rent monthly.
Treasury	Guards the house's money. The manager proposes a payment with an invoice fingerprint, and the steward must approve it.
CharterGovernor	Runs voting: two-thirds to change a rule, a 30-day wait, residents count 1.5×, steward veto on the rent cap

Why blockchain, reason 1: payments

```
Rent to owners = $700 a month
$700 ÷ 14,400 tokens = $0.0486 per token per month
$100 owner (10 tokens) = about $0.49 a month
Bank: 1,440 payments × $0.20–$0.50 = $288–$720 a month in fees
Base: 1 deposit + 1,440 claims at under 1¢ (67,067 gas each) = about $14 a month, which
OwnTheBlock pays
```

With a bank, the fees could eat most of the payout. On Base, the manager makes **one** deposit and the contract splits it by token count. It costs the same with 10 owners or 10,000.

Why blockchain, reason 2: trust (the stronger reason)

A database or payment processor works only if you trust whoever runs it. Here the rent cap, the 2% limit and the local share are written into the contract, so even I can't change them without a two-thirds owner vote and a 30-day wait. The steward co-signs every payment, and anyone can trace the money.

SAY IT IF A JUDGE PUSHES ON FEES

"Fees are only half my case. A payment processor works if you trust whoever runs it. My rules are written into the contract, so even I can't change them without a two-thirds vote and a 30-day wait. A spreadsheet can't promise that, because I control the spreadsheet."

How the 3% rent cap really works (three layers)

1. **The lease.** The cap is written into the lease, so the tenant has a legal right to it.
2. **The contract.** The manager reports the rent to the contract each month. A number above the cap is rejected, and the manager can't get paid.
3. **The steward.** A person co-signs every payment, so a rule-break gets noticed.

The honest limit: code can't control what a tenant pays in dollars. Blockchain enforces what gets recorded, and the lease and the steward cover the rest. Saying this out loud makes the rest of the answer more believable.

What is on-chain and what is not

Step	Where	Note
ID check	Both	Checked off-chain. Only the wallet, tier and a scrambled zip go on-chain.
Raising money	Both	The escrow bank holds dollars, and the contract records commitments publicly
Buying the house	Off	Attorney closing and county deed. Only a document fingerprint goes on-chain.
Collecting rent	Off	The property manager collects dollars

Monthly payout	On	One deposit, then owners claim
Votes and rules	On	Two-thirds vote plus a 30-day wait
Repair spending	On	Steward co-signs, with an invoice fingerprint
Legal owner list	Off	An SEC-registered transfer agent keeps it, mirroring the chain

Saying the off-chain list out loud shows judgment. The rubric itself warns that not every problem needs blockchain.

Proof it works (slide 6)

5	22	38	6
smart contracts	tests passing	test-run transactions	rule-breaks blocked

The tests are practice quizzes where I tried to trick the referees. The 38 transactions are a full neighborhood story played out on a practice blockchain on my computer.

THE RED NOTE ON SLIDE 6

The slide says **"Blocked by the code:** an early sale, a 10% rent hike, and a rushed rule change." That names 3, but the big number says 6. Check the demo output and either list all six or match the number. Also say "test blockchain," not "live on Base," unless you deploy to Base Sepolia first (the deployer wallet needs test ETH).

Built vs. planned

Piece	What it does	Status
Base + test USDC	Cheap payouts in digital dollars	BUILT (TEST)
5 contracts, 22 tests	The rules and the money flow	BUILT (TEST)
Web app (Block Simulator, demo)	Invest, payouts, Money Trail	BUILT
Smart Wallet	Log in with Face ID, no seed phrase	NEXT 90 DAYS
Paymaster	OwnTheBlock pays network fees, so owners never touch crypto	NEXT 90 DAYS
Onramp / offramp	Move money from and to a bank	NEXT 90 DAYS
Coinbase Verifications	A reusable on-chain ID check	EVALUATING
Extras	Document fingerprints, tenant rent-history record, lesson badges	PLANNED
Security audit	An outside firm checks the code before real money	REQUIRED FIRST

PART 7

The money for one house

Each house is paid for by its own $144,000 raise. That money never pays for the company.

Where the $144,000 goes

Use	Amount
Buy at as-is appraisal	$90,000
Repairs $35,000 + 15% cushion	$40,250
Closing + repair reserve	$5,110
Legal, accountant, portal	$5,760
OwnTheBlock fee (2%)	$2,880
Total (14,400 × $10)	**$144,000**

Monthly rent, top to bottom

Line	Monthly
Rent	$1,400
Vacancy (5%)	−$70
Management (8%)	−$112
Repair reserve (10%)	−$140
Platform (2%)	−$28
Taxes and insurance	−$270
Admin	−$80
Paid to owners	**$700**

```
Cash yield = $700 × 12 ÷ $144,000 = $8,400 ÷ $144,000 = 5.8% a year
Value on day one = $150,000 after-repair value ÷ 14,400 tokens = $10.63 behind each $10 token
```

Example: Jasmine, an A&T student, invests $100

- 10 tokens → about $0.49 a month, or $5.83 a year.
- After 5 years at 3% appreciation: about $116 at the exit + about $29 in payouts = about **$145** (about 8–9% a year, an estimate, not a promise).
- Downside: a drop of about 25% in home value is roughly break-even. Bigger drops lose money.

Why distressed homes: buying a house at full price would mean a $175,500 raise and only about 3.5% a year. Fixing up an eyesore returns about 8.5%. The mission and the math point the same way. Be honest that on pure return, this is like an index fund with less liquidity. The real advantages are local ownership, a voice and a path for the tenant to own.

Who fills the raise

Group	People	Average	Total
Alumni and supporters	540	$150	$81,000
Churches and local organizations	19	$2,000	$38,000
Residents	300	$50	$15,000
A&T and Bennett students	400	$25	$10,000

Total	**1,259**	**$144,000**

How OwnTheBlock makes money

- 2% of each raise: $2,880 per house.
- 2% of rent: about $336 per house a year.
- Later: licensing the platform to land trusts, community development nonprofits and cities that already own homes.

PART 8

Selling, exits and the buy-back

This is a long-term investment, typically 3 to 7 years. Most of the money comes back when the house itself is sold or bought by the tenant.

Situation	What happens
Months 0–12	Can't sell. The 12-month federal resale rule is enforced in code.
After 12 months, a buyer exists	No peer-to-peer trading in the pilot. Resale goes through a registered trading platform (an ATS) once I have a partner.
After 12 months, no buyer	The owner waits and keeps earning rent
The planned exit (years 3–7)	The tenant buys the home, or the community sells to a land trust. Every owner is paid by their share.
The raise doesn't fill	Everyone is refunded automatically, and the house is never bought

SAY IT IF ASKED "CAN I SELL MY TOKENS?"

"It's a long-term investment, typically three to seven years. For the first 12 months it can't be sold by law. After that, resale goes through a registered trading platform. The main exit is when the tenant buys the home or the community sells to a land trust, and then every owner is paid."

Why the family buy-back isn't an investor perk

The buy-back (option B) is a sweetener to get the family to say yes. The family only uses it when it helps them. Example with a $144,000 cost and a buy-back price of about $175,000 (cost + 4% a year for 5 years):

Market over 5 years	House worth	Family	Investors
Up 6% a year	~$201,000	Buys back, keeps ~$26K of upside	Miss the upside
Up 3% a year	~$174,000	About even	Fine
Down 3% a year	~$129,000	Doesn't buy back	Keep the loss

Investors still get about $42,000 of rent over 5 years in every case. Lead with options A and C, and keep B for Q&A.

STILL TO DECIDE

The Playbook mentions "buyback windows from the fund," but there is no pooled fund until a securities attorney approves it, so nothing guarantees a buyer yet. Options to pick from: a small liquidity reserve funded from rent, a waitlist of neighbors who missed the raise, and buybacks priced from the latest appraisal. Check each with counsel.

PART 9

The plan and the lean budget

Prove one house from start to finish in 18 months, for $70,000.

When	Goal	Done when
DONE	Working app, Block Simulator, 5 contracts, 22 tests, full test-chain demo. Built by me.	The prototype works
Months 0–3	Form the company, hire a securities attorney, add Smart Wallet and paymaster, get an independent audit, sign a steward and a crowdfunding portal	Audit passed, steward signed
Months 3–9	Get a house from city surplus or an heirs'-property family, file Form C with the SEC, raise $144,000	Raise fully funded
Months 9–18	Close, renovate, lease to a local family, start payouts on Base, begin houses 2 and 3	Monthly payouts running
Years 2–3	License to land trusts and community lenders. 5 cities, starting with HBCU communities.	25 homes

Rule: real money only moves after a lawyer signs off and the code passes an independent audit.

The budget: $70,000 for 18 months

Line	Amount	How it stays low
Securities attorney (LLC, Form C, Charter)	$25,000	Low end of the usual $20–50K, through a law clinic or startup legal program
Independent security audit	$15,000	Small custom code on audited OpenZeppelin parts, scanned with automated and AI tools first
Compliance (accountant, portal and transfer agent, insurance)	$15,000	About $5,000 each
Outreach and app	$8,000	AI-drafted money lessons, Coinbase Verifications for ID checks
Contingency	$7,000	For surprises
Salaries	$0	I'm building it myself
Total	**$70,000**	**About $3,900 a month**

Funded by	Amount
Grants and competitions (for example Base Builder grants)	$40,000
A CDFI or bank community program	$30,000
Total	**$70,000**

WHAT CHANGED

The budget went from $180,000 to $70,000. No stipends, no impact angels, and the ask on slide 12 is now $70,000. The two things that protect investors' money stay in: the attorney and the audit.

SAY IT · SLIDE 10

"I've kept the pilot lean: $70,000 over 18 months. I'm not taking a salary, and I built the prototype myself with AI tools. The money goes to the two things you can't shortcut, a securities attorney and an independent security audit."

BE READY

These are low-end planning numbers, not quotes. Working solo and unpaid may stretch the timeline. Funding sources are targets, not commitments. One real quote from an attorney or auditor before Tuesday would make this slide much stronger.

PART 10

Risks, competition and impact

Risks and fixes (slide 11)

Risk	Fix
Can't fill the raise	All-or-nothing refunds. Four groups invest: residents, students, alumni and churches.
Securities law	A registered crowdfunding portal, one LLC per house, the 12-month lockup in code
Code bug or hack	22 tests plus an independent audit before real money. Two keys on every payment. Lost wallets can be recovered through ID.
Repairs run over or a tenant leaves	15% repair cushion, staged payments, 5% vacancy cushion, 10% reserve
A seller won't wait for the raise	Start with city surplus and heirs' property. Use a bridge loan, repaid by the raise, for fast closes. NEW
Home values fall	Bought below repaired value, no mortgage, a first-loss partner (being pursued) covers the first 10%
Rules seen as excluding people	Rules favor residency, never race. An attorney reviews every Charter.

Competition (slide 7)

	Invest from $10	Locals first	Rules in code	Tenant can buy
Fundrise, Arrived	Yes	No	No	No
RealT, Lofty	Yes	No	Partly	No
Community land trusts	No	Yes	Partly	Partly
OwnTheBlock	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**

Say "none combine all four," never "no one has ever done this." Verify competitors' current features before Tuesday.

Impact at scale (slide 8)

1
home · Greensboro pilot, first 18 months

25
homes · 5 cities, years 2–3

500
homes · 100 HBCU communities × 5

```
500 homes × $144,000 = $72 million of homes owned by their neighborhoods
500 homes × $700 × 12 months = $4.2 million a year of rent staying local
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Who wins: residents own their block, tenants get capped rent and a path to buy, and students make a first investment. That's Coinbase's mission, economic freedom, starting on your block. These are targets, not forecasts. Small local businesses and commercial buildings are a future idea, not part of this pitch.

PART 11

The 12-slide pitch

Five minutes, about 680 words. Aim to finish at 4:45. The full script is in the deck's speaker notes.

#	Slide	Rubric	The point in one line	Time
1	Cover	Problem	My story and Black Wall Street	0:25
2	What I grew up watching	Problem (5)	Vacant homes, outside buyers, the 45% vs 74% gap	0:25
3	Solution	Benefits	$10 shares in an LLC, residents first, rent and votes	0:30
4	Why blockchain: payments	Blockchain (20)	One deposit pays everyone for under a cent each	0:20
5	Why blockchain: trust	Blockchain (20)	Even I can't change the rules	0:30
6	It's already built	Blockchain / Feasibility	5 contracts, 22 tests, rule-breaks blocked	0:20
7	Competition	Innovation (15)	No one else combines all four	0:25
8	Impact at scale	Benefits (15)	$72M of homes owned locally, Coinbase's mission	0:30
9	The plan	Action Plan (20)	One house in 18 months, legal and audit first	0:25
10	Budget: $70,000	Action Plan (20)	Lean, no salary, protects investors	0:20
11	Risks I've planned for	Feasibility (15)	Refunds, portal, audit, cushions, bridge loan	0:25
12	My ask	Close	Steward partner, $70,000, mentorship from Base	0:15

Backup slides for Q&A only: five app-demo screens, Why Now, How OwnTheBlock Makes Money, and Who Wins.

THE CLOSE · SLIDE 12

"My ask: a steward partner and a first house in Greensboro, $70,000 for the pilot, and mentorship from Base for the audit and launch. Neighbors shouldn't have to watch anymore. Fix the block. Own the block. Thank you."

PART 12

Q&A answers

Three minutes is about four questions. Keep each answer to one sentence plus one number.

If they ask	Say
Why not just a database?	A database can store the list, but it can't make tiny payments cheap or stop its own operator from changing the rules.
Banks can batch payments cheaply.	Even at 25 cents, a 49-cent payout loses half. And fees are only half my case. The other half is trust: I can't change the rules.
How does code enforce the rent cap?	Three layers: the lease, the contract rejecting any rent above the cap, and the steward co-signing every payment.
Aren't you still using a bank?	Yes, where the law requires it: an escrow bank during the raise and a transfer agent for the official list. Blockchain runs the rest.
Is this legal?	Each house's LLC raises under SEC Regulation Crowdfunding through a registered portal, with a 12-month lockup in code.
Who owns the LLC?	The token holders. I manage it, and a community steward co-signs every payment.
Who speaks for the community?	A steward today, and a resident-elected board as houses multiply.
49 cents is nothing.	The impact is the house, its rent and its value staying in the neighborhood, and a tenant becoming an owner.
Can you really raise $144,000?	540 alumni at $150, 19 churches at $2,000, 300 residents at $50, 400 students at $25. If it misses, everyone is refunded.
Can I sell my tokens?	Not for 12 months. Then through a registered platform. The main exit is the tenant buying, in years 3–7.
Isn't this gentrification?	Residents buy first, rent is capped at 3% a year, the tenant can buy, and the profits stay local.
What if home values fall?	Bought below repaired value with no mortgage. A drop of about 25% is roughly break-even.
Is $70,000 realistic?	Low-end estimates, not quotes. No salary, and the attorney and audit stay in. It may take longer solo.
You're one person?	I built the prototype myself, and I'm recruiting a securities attorney, a broker and an accountant as advisors.
Why the family buy-back?	A sweetener to get heirs to say yes, priced at cost + 4% a year so investors get money back plus a return.
Is this only for Black communities?	The rules favor residency and local ties, never race. I start around HBCUs because that's where I see the need.

PART 13

What still needs to change

Everything here is in red because it still needs action. Sunday, Nov 8 is the slide deadline. Tuesday, Nov 10 is the pitch.

Before Sunday, Nov 8

- [ ] Email Jade to confirm the date, the format (5 + 3) and how travel is booked.
- [ ] Send Jade the final slides and flight details.
- [ ] **Slide 6 red note:** make the "6 rule-breaks blocked" number match the demo output, or list all six.
- [ ] Verify the 45% / 74% Census figures (slide 2).
- [ ] Get one real bank quote for per-payment ACH fees (slide 4's ~$500 a month).
- [ ] Optional: swap in your own photo of a neighborhood you've seen (slide 2).
- [ ] Optional: fund the deployer wallet with test ETH and deploy to Base Sepolia so slide 6 can say "live on a public test network."

Before Tuesday, Nov 10

- [ ] Try for one real number from an attorney or auditor to back the $70,000 budget.
- [ ] Verify competitors' current features (Fundrise, Arrived, RealT, Lofty).
- [ ] Rehearse out loud with a timer at least five times, finishing at 4:45.
- [ ] Run a mock Q&A with someone pushing on blockchain, the rent cap, the budget and selling tokens.

Decisions still open

- [ ] Community board: who holds the fifth seat, how residents are elected, and when it starts.
- [ ] Liquidity: liquidity reserve, waitlist, or appraisal-priced buybacks (check with counsel).
- [ ] Buy-back price: keep cost + 4% a year, or use the greater of that and the current appraisal.

ALREADY DONE

Deck rebuilt to 12 rubric-mapped slides · your story as the opening · Ms. Jenkins removed · solo "I" wording · bridge loan added to risks · lean $70,000 budget and ask · model answers in the speaker notes.